# Wave modes depend on the complete model

Field count is not, by itself, a mode count or interface-system dimension.

**Classical elastic / thermoelastic**
Mechanical displacement; temperature joins when the coupled thermoelastic equations are included.

**Relaxation, phase-lag, thermal-displacement, memory, or fractional models**
Thermal branches and their speeds/support depend on the selected operator, parameters, and initial-boundary data.

**Piezoelectric and other coupled-field media**
Electrical, porous, magnetic, or carrier fields alter the eigenproblem; quasi-electrostatic models are not EM-wave models.

**Micropolar, gradient, and nonlocal media**
Additional kinematics or spatial operators change boundary data and dispersion in model-specific ways.

**No universal mode count, speed, attenuation, or interface-matrix size is asserted.**

Derive and classify roots from the actual field equations and boundary conditions.